



MONTHLY UPDATE

Tanzania: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 26 systems and instruments tracked, 14 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Payments carried the month. An [order under the electronic transactions Act](#) came into operation on 1 July 2026, making nine scheduled classes of transaction electronic-payment-only; on [31 July the central bank set caps on several retail charges and its governor rejected a general price cap](#), saying charges are already low and competition will cut fees within six months.

The ICT ministry set out an artificial-intelligence position abroad before adopting one at home. At an international meeting on 18 July it stated that a [national AI data centre is under construction and that a Kiswahili large language model is written into the 2050 vision](#); on [30 July guidelines were still being drafted](#).

A ministerial inspection of the national backbone on 24 July recorded [942.5 km built in one region against 65 citizens connected region-wide](#).

Infrastructure

The minister inspected the national backbone at Mpwapwa on 24 July. The network stands at about [14,000 km carrying four public data centres and a third landing cable](#); in the region inspected, 942.5 km had been built against 65 people connected. The regional manager stated that phase one connected government offices and public institutions, with individual citizens next. At the same inspection [636 masts were stated due in March 2027, with a second programme of 280 masts under way](#) with no cost, financier or completion date given.

On 29 July the Kenyan and Tanzanian ministers [launched a terrestrial fibre link across the border, integrating the national backbone with submarine cable capacity](#). No capacity, cost or financing was stated, and the base does not reconcile it against the 2025 connection on the route.

The state operator [gave students of a technical institute hands-on training on backbone technologies](#), reported 23 July with no intake number or cadence; and a data-centre group named its Tanzanian site as under development while raising [committed capital from US\\$350m to US\\$380m](#), giving no Tanzanian size, cost or date.

Digital public infrastructure

The [mandatory electronic payments order came into operation on 1 July 2026](#). It is an order under the electronic transactions Act rather than regulations, as widely mis-reported; it is prospective only, businesses taking cash at commencement have until 1 January 2027 to comply, and cash remains legal tender.

One month in, the price of using the rails became the argument. On 31 July the central bank [capped bank-to-wallet interoperability at TZS 5,000 above TZS 500,000, single instant transactions and retail bank-to-bank transfers at TZS 2,000, and card payments at zero](#), removing intra-bank transfer charges and a Zanzibar card surcharge. The same day the governor rejected a general price cap demanded by users and analysts; one analyst put the worked cost at about TZS 3,500 per TZS 100,000 paid and argued that the mandate manufactures avoidance.

A technical meeting in Zanzibar from 7 to 11 July [advanced the governance, commercial and risk frameworks for a cross-border instant-payment corridor with Rwanda](#). No launch date was set.

The public procurement appeals authority [directed all domestic and international bidders to lodge challenges through its online module and announced plans to integrate it with the judiciary's system](#), reported 31 July, with hearings by video conference already taking cases from bidders in five other countries. No date is attached to the integration.

At an agricultural exhibition on 4 August the e-government agency stated that [more than 6,000 cooperative societies are registered](#) on its management system, and described a farmer-records and permits system and a fertiliser monitoring system. No user counts, spend or timeline were given.

Governance and regulation

The data protection commission and the open university [opened a certification programme for data protection officers on 14 July](#), the university training and assessing and the commission certifying, aimed at government, finance, telecommunications, healthcare, education and technology. It answers the statutory officer duty; no intake number, fee or cohort date was published.

At a university health conference on 31 July the government stated [three requirements: that health data be stored inside Tanzania, that healthcare AI systems be approved by the relevant authorities, and that local capacity to build them be developed](#). No instrument and no approving authority was named, and a dedicated regulator was called for from the floor rather than announced.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

At an international AI meeting on 18 July the ICT minister stated that a [national AI data centre is under construction, justified on ending raw-data export and training models on domestic hydro and geothermal power](#), and that a Kiswahili large language model is set out in the national vision. No site, cost, capacity, operator or completion date was given for the centre, and no developer, budget, corpus or timetable for the model.

Twelve days later, at a training event on 30 July, an archives officer said [government is still drafting AI guidelines; an external policy outlook published the same day placed Tanzania among states still developing a strategy](#).

Three deployments were reported. A cardiac institute stated on 16 July that its [digital patient tracking system is in use for medical-camp follow-up](#), alongside AI-enabled echocardiography and contactless vital-signs monitoring, with no patient volumes or procurement route. A peer-reviewed study published 3 August reported a ports enquiry chatbot at [95.1% weighted task success with fifteen domain experts](#), with no production deployment. At the agricultural exhibition on 4 August a university showed [a medicine-authenticity lookup at development stage and a voice-driven mobile-money service for blind users in testing](#); both are student prototypes, self-reported, with no institutional partner, regulator or funder named.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

The Zanzibar postgraduate technology campus graduated its second cohort on 5 July: [129 students, about half from East Africa and 30% women, with a stated aim of 100 startups](#). The figures are institution-reported and unaudited.

Training opened in Dar es Salaam on 27 July for [110 participants from public, private and non-governmental institutions, across AI, cybersecurity, personal data protection and emerging technologies](#). No budget, duration, certification or repeat cadence was stated.

Three external tracks opened in one week, none priced. On 17 July [cooperation frameworks were agreed with Brazil and Poland on AI strategy, digital government and cybersecurity research](#), with memoranda proposed and none signed; [youth and technology-skills agreements with Russia were in drafting](#). On 24 July the ministry's permanent secretary signed a [memorandum in Shanghai covering ICT infrastructure, AI, digital public service infrastructure, developing local professionals, and manufacture and assembly of digital equipment](#). The ministry's own release states no commitment amount, term or financing structure.

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